VOL. I WEEKDAY EDITION

THE SPACEX DISPATCH

Weekday briefing on SpaceX launches, Starlink, AI and the SPCX stock

FRIDAY, OCTOBER 16, 2026 MARKET DATA AS OF THU OCT 15 CLOSE

THE MORNING PICTURE

USSF-481 flies, Dragon docks, and SpaceX lends Tesla its thrusters

A Falcon 9 launched the classified USSF-481 mission from Vandenberg at 8:01 p.m. EDT Thursday, 17 minutes into its window, and the booster landed on its 28th flight, Spaceflight Now reported. An hour later, at a SpaceX test site in McGregor, Texas, Tesla's new Roadster flew on SpaceX cold-gas thrusters. "Tesla x SpaceX," Elon Musk posted.

Cargo Dragon docked at the space station Thursday morning. Ukraine says its Starlink and Starshield service is back to full capacity. Musk says the Star Mind orbital computer SpaceX is building with Nvidia reaches volume production next year, and SpaceXAI testifies to the New York City Council at 10 a.m. EDT today. SPCX fell 2.33% to $148.62.

TODAY · 10 A.M. EDT

SpaceXAI before the New York City Council

Fri Oct 16 · 10:00 a.m. EDT · Committee on Technology, Council Chambers, City Hall

The hearing is an oversight session on "the risks posed by artificial intelligence" (Council calendar). The Council subpoenaed Musk and SpaceXAI on September 28; Anthropic, Google, Meta and OpenAI testified at an October 5 hearing that SpaceX skipped, and SpaceX agreed to appear after the Council said it would ask a judge to enforce the subpoena, CNBC reported. The Council has not said who will testify for the company, amNY reported.

I · HUMAN SPACEFLIGHT & LAUNCHES

A classified payload, and a Dragon at Harmony

USSF-481 went south from California, and Dragon delivered the station's last new solar arrays.



A Falcon 9 lifts off from Space Launch Complex 4E at Vandenberg Space Force Base on Dec. 16, 2022. USSF-481 flew from the same pad on Thursday.
PHOTO: NASA/KEEGAN BARBER · PUBLIC DOMAIN

USSF-481

The rocket, also listed as TH-2 in public notices, took a southerly path; hazard warnings suggest a low Earth orbit inclined about 80 degrees, Spaceflight Now reported. Booster B1081 landed on Of Course I Still Love You a little more than eight minutes after liftoff, that ship's 228th landing and the 671st Falcon booster landing. B1081 has also flown Crew-7, CRS-29, PACE and 16 Starlink missions (SpaceX). It was the second "TH" mission in as many months, after USSF-259 on September 16.

CRS-35 at the station

"Docking confirmed – Dragon has arrived at the @Space_Station!" SpaceX posted at 10:29 a.m. EDT Thursday. The cargo ship carries more than 6,300 pounds, including the last pair of ISS Roll-Out Solar Arrays, and is to stay about a month (NASA).

Rocket parts in a car

"SpaceX has used thrusters to position spacecraft for decades. Making them work in a vehicle instead of a vacuum took all-new hardware & controls," Tesla posted. The Roadster's thrusters were supplied by SpaceX and rated at more than 80 kilonewtons, and the event was held at SpaceX's McGregor testing facility, Car and Driver reported. Some watchers saw the collaboration as Musk building interest in merging the two companies, Reuters reported.

II · UPCOMING FLIGHTS

Bandwagon-5 on Monday, two Starlinks after

Every SpaceX launch on the books for the next two months, with how firm each date is and where it comes from. Times are Eastern Daylight Time (EDT).

DATE / TIME (EDT)	VEHICLE	MISSION	PAD	STATUS	SOURCES
Mon Oct 19, 6:30 a.m.	Falcon 9	Bandwagon-5 mid-inclination rideshare; booster B1085, 19th flight	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Tentative	Launch Library 2; FAA
Tue Oct 20, 6:14 p.m.	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-15; booster B1063, 36th flight	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2; FAA
Sat Oct 24, 1:29 a.m.	Falcon 9	Starlink 15-16	SLC-4E, Vandenberg	Tentative	Launch Library 2
NET Nov 8	Starship	Flight 15, Ship 42 and Booster 22; Musk says a ship catch will be attempted	Pad 2, Starbase, Texas	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)
NET Nov 30	Falcon 9	Cygnus NG-25 cargo to the ISS	SLC-40, Cape Canaveral	Preliminary	Launch Library 2
NET Thu Dec 10	Starship	Flight 16 (Starlink Group 30-1), likely Ship 43 and Booster 23	Possibly LC-39A, Kennedy	Preliminary	NASASpaceflight (unofficial)

Status: Confirmed means the operator or NASA has announced the date and time. Tentative means a specific date appears in published schedules but has not been confirmed by SpaceX or its customer. Preliminary means only a no-earlier-than (NET) month or an unofficial target. FAA airspace windows: Bandwagon-5 6:30 to 8:13 a.m. EDT Monday; Starlink 15-15 6:14 to 10:57 p.m. EDT Tuesday; Starlink 15-16 1:29 to 6:12 a.m. EDT Saturday, October 24. Date changes since Thursday's issue: USSF-481 lifted off at 8:01 p.m. rather than the 7:44 p.m. window opening, with no reason given; Cygnus NG-25 is now listed NET November 30. Pads: Space Launch Complex 4 East (SLC-4E), Space Launch Complex 40 (SLC-40), Launch Complex 39A (LC-39A).

III · STARLINK

Ukraine says service is back to full capacity

The restriction lasted more than a day; who ordered it is still unclear.

Ukraine's Starlink and Starshield services, slowed earlier this week, have been restored to full capacity, a Ukrainian official told Axios. The official also said Ukraine struck a Russian oil refinery overnight, defying President Trump's demand that it stop. "It's still unclear to many inside the Trump administration and the Ukrainian government whether Trump ordered the satellite restrictions," Axios reported. A defense ministry source also told the Kyiv Independent that service had been restored.

QUICK HIT

In the air. "Starlink is really that good," Musk wrote, quoting a frequent Delta flyer who switched to United for its Starlink Wi-Fi, and he shared United's tool for checking whether a flight has it.

IV · AI & COMPUTE

Star Mind, "far better than almost anyone expects"

Nvidia's Jensen Huang says the two companies are designing a server for space.

"One particular new market that we're going to go explore together is putting data centers out in space," Huang said on the BG2 podcast, adding that the companies' engineers are creating "a new type of server, a new type of architecture that might be super good in space and on Earth," Tesla News Wire reported. "Old friends are the best friends. Jensen rocks," Musk replied. "The Star Mind computer being co-engineered by SpaceX and Nvidia is far better than almost anyone expects and will reach volume production next year." Asked about a goal of 10 gigawatts of compute by the end of 2027, he wrote, "Maybe more than 10GW."

SpaceX has said the first-generation Starmind satellite is based on an optimized Nvidia Vera Rubin NVL72 system, with

launches as early as the fourth quarter of 2027, Benzinga reported. Its IPO filing warned that orbital AI compute involves "unproven technologies, and may not achieve commercial viability," Reuters reported in April.

QUICK HIT

Grok Bot. "Never seen anything grow as fast as @Grok @Bot! And there is no free tier," Musk posted. Of Anthropic giving evaluators from METR employee-like access to assess its safety practices, he wrote, "SpaceX will probably do the same."

V · FILINGS: SEC, FAA & FCC

Quiet at the SEC; Starbase comments run to November 30

No new SEC filings or FAA Federal Register notices since Thursday's issue; the Starbase review remains open.

FAA

Notice of intent · Oct 14 — The FAA will prepare a Programmatic Environmental Impact Statement (PEIS) on SpaceX's proposal to increase Starship-Super Heavy operations at the Boca Chica launch site at Starbase and to add Starship landing and expenditure locations (docket FAA-2026-12808; 91 FR 65289). Later license changes and temporary airspace closures fall within its scope. Federal Register

What is proposed — Phase 1 allows up to 100 launches and 200 landings a year, at any time on any day; Phase 2, expected within several years, raises the cap to 456 launches and 912 landings, with launches on weekdays only, Invezz reported. The current limit is 25 launches and 50 landings. Four in-person scoping meetings are set for November 17 and 19 and a virtual one for November 18; comments are due November 30, SpacePolicyOnline reported.

Notice of intent · Sep 29 — Scoping comments on Starship at Space Launch Complex 37, Cape Canaveral (up to 76 launches a year), closed October 14 (docket FAA-2026-10792). Federal Register

SEC

> No filings for Space Exploration Technologies Corp. (CIK 0001181412) were accepted on the SEC's Electronic Data Gathering, Analysis, and Retrieval system (EDGAR) between 8:00 a.m. EDT Thursday and 8:15 a.m. EDT Friday. Latest insider filings:

Form 4/A · Sep 30 · Antonio Gracias, director — Amends his report of the September 11 in-kind distribution of 42,790,223 shares by Valor entities; 460,624,307 shares afterward. Filing

Form 4 · Sep 24 · Gwynne Shotwell, President and Chief Operating Officer — Exercised options for 342,170 shares on September 22 and sold the same number at weighted-average prices of $151.15 to $154.72; 2,472,035 shares afterward. Filing

FCC

Oct 8 · 800 MHz purchase — SpaceX's purchase of Grain's nationwide 800 MHz licenses is subject to FCC approval. Grain

Oct 6 · Gen2 direct-to-device order — 15,000 satellites granted in part; surety bond due November 4. Exterra

Oct 29 · Open meeting — Votes on more spectrum for Supplemental Coverage from Space and a proposed 25 MHz auction. Broadband Breakfast

Takeaways

1. Falcon 9 launched USSF-481 at 8:01 p.m. EDT; booster B1081 landed on its 28th flight.
2. CRS-35 Dragon docked at the ISS at 10:29 a.m. EDT Thursday.
3. Ukraine says Starlink and Starshield service is back to full capacity.
4. Musk says the Star Mind orbital computer with Nvidia reaches volume production next year.
5. SpaceXAI testifies to the New York City Council at 10 a.m. EDT today; SPCX fell 2.33%.

SOURCES

Posts by @elonmusk, @SpaceX and @Tesla on X; Spaceflight Now, SpaceX, NASA, FAA, Federal Register, Launch Library 2, NASASpaceflight, NYC Council; CNBC, amNY, Car and Driver, Reuters, Axios, Kyiv Independent, Tesla News Wire, Benzinga, Invezz, SpacePolicyOnline, Grain Management, Exterra, Broadband Breakfast; SEC EDGAR; Yahoo Finance via yfinance; CBOE. Photo: NASA (public domain).

The SpaceX Dispatch is an independent weekday digest of public news, X posts, regulatory filings and market data about Space Exploration Technologies Corp., and is not affiliated with the company. Quotes are verbatim; emoji in quoted posts are omitted for print. Market data are delayed and may be revised. Not investment advice.

Down 2.3% after an early dip below $141

SPCX touched $140.66 in the first half hour, recovered most of the drop and closed down 2.33% on above-average volume while the S&P 500 rose 0.33%. Evercore ISI raised its target to $275 from $230 on Friday, according to Yahoo Finance.

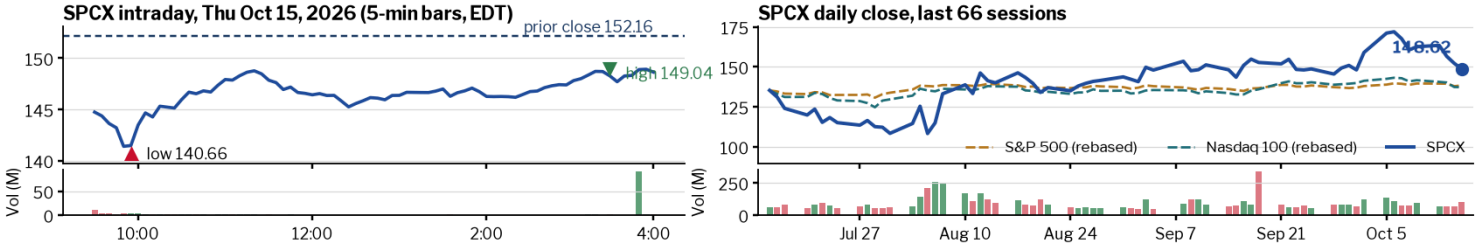
CLOSE	CHANGE	OPEN	DAY HIGH	DAY LOW
$148.62	−$3.54	$146.91	$149.04	$140.66
Thu Oct 15, 4:00 p.m. EDT	−2.33% vs $152.16	regular session	3:25 p.m. EDT bar	9:55 a.m. EDT bar

VOLUME	RANGE SINCE IPO	MARKET CAP	5-DAY / 1-MONTH	SINCE LISTING
100.79M	$105–$226	$1.96T	−7.44% / −1.50%	+10.1%
+10.1% vs 30-session avg 91.52M	no 52-week history (listed Jun 12)	13.18B Class A+B shares × close; $2.02T with Cursor shares	5 and 21 sessions	vs $135 IPO price; −7.66% vs first close

SINCE IPO, OCT 15

low $104.83 · Aug 3 — close $148.62 — high $225.64 · Jun 16

50-day avg $147.52



As of close Oct 15, 2026; times EDT. Source: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (regular session, unadjusted). Dashed navy = prior close; triangles = session high/low; volume green/red = up/down vs prior bar; index lines rebased to the first close shown.

RELATIVE PERFORMANCE, AS OF OCT 15 CLOSE

TICKER	1-DAY	5-DAY	1-MONTH	SINCE JUN 12
SPCX	**−2.33%**	**−7.44%**	**−1.50%**	**−7.66%**
S&P 500	+0.33%	−0.27%	+2.55%	+4.21%
Nasdaq 100	−0.05%	−2.57%	+3.42%	+1.01%
RKLB	−6.64%	−19.23%	−13.27%	−46.04%
ASTS	+5.51%	−21.90%	−24.99%	−46.05%
IRDM	−1.73%	−5.40%	−4.84%	−4.92%

OPTIONS SNAPSHOT (CBOE, RETRIEVED FRI OCT 16, 8:13 A.M. EDT)

EXPIRY	CALL OI	PUT OI	P/C	ATM IV	TOP CALL / PUT
Oct 19	45,164	34,788	0.77	44.5%	$170 / $148
Oct 21	20,747	11,020	0.53	49.5%	$170 / $147
Oct 23	80,165	90,974	1.13	51.8%	$165 / $140
All expiries	**2,422,846**	**2,450,589**	**1.01**		**30-day IV index 55.9**

ANALYST CONSENSUS · OCT 16

Strong buy	8
Buy	22
Hold	5
Sell	3
Strong sell	0
Mean (1 = strong buy)	1.79
Mean target (31 analysts)	$221.26 (+48.9%)
Median target	$225.00
High / low target	$450.00 / $118.00

SHORT INTEREST & OWNERSHIP

Short interest, Sep 30	181.00M
Change vs. prior report	+4.2%
Short % of float	2.71%
Days to cover	2.01
Held by insiders	12.73%
Held by institutions	48.64%
Alphabet, Jun 30	7.16%
Valor Management, Jun 30	6.54%

VALUATION & TREND · OCT 15 CLOSE

Trailing P/E (EPS −$1.10)	—
Forward P/E (EPS est. $1.99)	74.8
Price/sales (rev. $23.04B)	85.0
Beta	—
50-day average	$147.52 (+0.7%)
200-day average	—
Q3 EPS est. (16 analysts)	$0.17
Q3 revenue est. (17)	$12.98B

RECENT RATING ACTIONS

DATE	FIRM	RATING	TARGET
Oct 16	Evercore ISI	Outperform	$230 to $275
Oct 9	Barclays	Overweight (initiated)	$254
Oct 9	TD Cowen	Buy	$200
Oct 8	Erste Group	Hold (initiated)	—
Oct 7	Susquehanna	Neutral	$144 to $173
Sep 30	Macquarie	Outperform	$250
Sep 28	Deutsche Bank	Buy	$235

CATALYST CALENDAR

DATE	EVENT
Fri Oct 16	Monthly options expiry; NYC Council hearing, 10 a.m.
Sat Oct 24	**Lock-up tranche: up to 328.4M more**
Thu Oct 29	FCC open meeting: direct-to-device spectrum votes
Tue Nov 3	Q3 results (Yahoo estimate, not confirmed)
Wed Nov 4	FCC surety-bond deadline (15,000 satellites)
Tue Dec 8	180-day lock-up ends

Prices, volume, returns, averages: Yahoo Finance via yfinance (unadjusted; 30-session average excludes Oct 15). Consensus, targets, ratings, short interest (Sep 30), ownership (Jun 30, % of Class A) and estimates: Yahoo Finance, retrieved Fri Oct 16, 8:13 a.m. EDT; Erste Group via TheFly. P/E is price to earnings per share (EPS); price/sales uses trailing 12-month revenue. A dash marks a measure that does not apply yet: trailing P/E (negative EPS), beta and the 200-day average (listed Jun 12). Options: CBOE delayed quotes; open interest (OI) and IV as of Thursday's close; P/C is put/call by OI; ATM IV at the $149 strike. Shares: 10-Q cover (7,696,293,669 Class A + 5,485,486,276 Class B, Jul 28); $2.02T adds 391,041,680 Cursor merger shares (8-K). IPO price and lock-ups: prospectus (424B4); 1.3B more shares unlock two trading days after Q3 results. FCC dates: Exterra.